

HOUSE BILL No. 1109

DIGEST OF INTRODUCED BILL

Citations Affected: IC 10-17-17.

Synopsis: Homeless veterans initiative shelter program. Establishes the Hoosier homeless veteran initiative for the purpose of providing a means for homeless veterans to have access to temporary shelter during the veteran's rehabilitation. Provides that the initiative shall be coordinated and administered by the Indiana department of veterans' affairs (department) in consultation with the Indiana department of health. Requires each homeless shelter with at least 25 beds to reserve at least one bed out of every 25 beds for a homeless veteran. Provides that a homeless shelter or other entity may apply to the department to become a participating shelter. Provides that a participating shelter shall receive grants from the department. Provides that a participating shelter shall provide food and housing and other services prescribed by the department for a participating veteran for a period consisting of the lesser of: (1) two years; or (2) the period necessary for the veteran to complete the requirements necessary for the participating veteran to receive a housing voucher in accordance with the United States Department of Housing and Urban Development's (HUD) HUD-VASH program. Provides that a homeless veteran who is not married may request to become a participating veteran in a manner prescribed by the department. Provides that the homeless veteran shall not be required to test negative on a drug or alcohol test to obtain initial placement in a participating shelter. Requires that a participating veteran receive services and meet certain requirements to remain eligible for placement in a participating facility.

Effective: July 1, 2026.

Haggard

January 5, 2026, read first time and referred to Committee on Veterans Affairs and Public Safety.



Second Regular Session of the 124th General Assembly (2026)

PRINTING CODE. Amendments: Whenever an existing statute (or a section of the Indiana Constitution) is being amended, the text of the existing provision will appear in this style type, additions will appear in **this style type**, and deletions will appear in ~~this style type~~.

Additions: Whenever a new statutory provision is being enacted (or a new constitutional provision adopted), the text of the new provision will appear in **this style type**. Also, the word **NEW** will appear in that style type in the introductory clause of each SECTION that adds a new provision to the Indiana Code or the Indiana Constitution.

Conflict reconciliation: Text in a statute in *this style type* or ~~this style type~~ reconciles conflicts between statutes enacted by the 2025 Regular Session of the General Assembly.

HOUSE BILL No. 1109

A BILL FOR AN ACT to amend the Indiana Code concerning public safety.

Be it enacted by the General Assembly of the State of Indiana:

1 SECTION 1. IC 10-17-17 IS ADDED TO THE INDIANA CODE
2 AS A **NEW** CHAPTER TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE
3 JULY 1, 2026]:

4 **Chapter 17. Hoosier Homeless Veteran Initiative**

5 **Sec. 1. The following definitions apply throughout this chapter:**

6 (1) "Department" refers to the Indiana department of
7 veterans' affairs established by IC 10-17-1-2.

8 (2) "Homeless shelter" means a publicly or privately operated
9 facility that is designated to provide temporary living
10 arrangements, including:

11 (A) congregate shelters;

12 (B) transitional housing; or

13 (C) hotels or motels paid for by charitable organizations or
14 government programs.

15 (3) "Homeless veteran" refers to a veteran who has served at
16 least six (6) months in the armed forces of the United States
17 (as defined in IC 5-9-4-3) or national guard (as defined in



IC 5-9-4-4) and is homeless.

(4) "Initiative" refers to the Hoosier homeless veteran initiative established by section 2 of this chapter.

(5) "Participating shelter" means a public or privately operated facility that is approved under section 4 of this chapter to provide a homeless veteran separate temporary living quarters in:

(A) a house;

(B) an apartment; or

(C) a group of rooms or a single room.

(6) "Participating veteran" means a veteran who is not married who agrees to be placed in a participating shelter under section 5 of this chapter.

(7) "Veteran" means any individual who has served in the armed forces of the United States (as defined in IC 5-9-4-3) or national guard (as defined in IC 5-9-4-4) regardless of separation status.

Sec. 2. The Hoosier homeless veteran initiative is established for the purpose of providing a means for homeless veterans to have access to temporary shelter during the veteran's rehabilitation. The initiative shall be coordinated and administered by the department in consultation with the Indiana department of health.

Sec. 3. (a) This section applies to a homeless shelter that provides temporary living arrangements to at least twenty-five (25) individuals.

(b) Except as provided in subsection (c), a homeless shelter shall reserve at least one (1) bed for a homeless veteran for every twenty-five (25) beds provided to homeless individuals.

(c) The provisions of this section do not supersede applicable fire codes or public health and safety laws.

Sec. 4. (a) A homeless shelter or another entity may apply to become a participating shelter in the initiative in a manner prescribed by the department. Except as provided in section 5 of this chapter, a participating shelter must provide food and housing and other services prescribed by the department for the participating veteran for a period consisting of the lesser of:

(1) two (2) years; or

(2) the period necessary for the participating veteran to complete the requirements necessary to receive housing vouchers in accordance with the United States Department of Housing and Urban Development's (HUD) HUD-VASH program authorized by P.L.110-161, 121 Stat. 1844.



(b) A participating shelter is eligible for grants under IC 10-17-13.5-4, in an amount determined by the department.

Sec. 5. (a) A homeless veteran who is not married may request to become a participating veteran in a manner prescribed by the department. The department may approve the homeless veteran's request in a manner prescribed by the department. A participating veteran is eligible for placement in a participating shelter.

(b) The homeless veteran shall not be required to test negative on a drug or alcohol test to obtain initial placement under this section.

(c) To maintain placement under this section, the participating veteran must:

(1) maintain contact with a county service officer or counselor approved by the department in a manner prescribed by the department;

(2) present a copy of the veteran's DD 214 (as defined in IC 10-17-15-1) within sixty (60) days after the participating veteran's initial placement under this section;

(3) be employed or volunteer for at least ten (10) hours per week;

(4) meet eligibility requirements to receive Medicaid under IC 12-15 within six (6) weeks after the participating veteran's initial placement under this section;

(5) participate in applicable rehabilitative services including:

(A) mental health counseling;

(B) addiction counseling; or

(C) job training or education programs offered by the United States Department of Veterans' Affairs, the department, or other programs approved by the department;

(6) enroll in the United States Department of Housing and Urban Development's (HUD) HUD-VASH program authorized by P.L.110-161, 121 Stat. 1844, to receive housing vouchers;

(7) submit to regular drug and alcohol testing, in a manner prescribed by the department; and

(8) submit signed monthly statements, on a form prescribed by the department, to the participating shelter indicating the veteran is in compliance with subdivisions (1) through (7).

(d) A participating veteran who does not comply with the requirements provided in this section may result in the participating veteran being determined to be ineligible to



1 participate in the initiative. A veteran who is determined to be
2 ineligible under this subsection is ineligible to reapply to
3 participate in the initiative for a period of one (1) year from the
4 date the veteran is determined to be ineligible under this
5 subsection.

6 Sec. 6. (a) Beginning October 1, 2026, and each quarter
7 thereafter, a participating shelter shall provide a report to the
8 department, containing information relating to the progress of
9 participating veterans in a manner prescribed by the department.

10 (b) Beginning January 1, 2027, and each quarter thereafter, the
11 department shall provide a report to the Indiana department of
12 health summarizing the reports received from participating
13 shelters.

